User Story Map

Map the user's journey, then slice it into releases that each deliver a complete, usable path.

Break Down Work · Inspired by Jeff Patton's Story Mapping · Walking Skeleton · Release Slices

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

LEGEND

- Blue Sticky = Activity (backbone)
- Yellow Sticky = User Task
- Green Sticky = Story / Detail

Persona / user: Busy parent who shops weekly

Their goal: Repeat the weekly shop in under a minute

Product / epic: Reorder made easy

1 Activities

The backbone: the big things users do, in order

USER JOURNEY → LEFT TO RIGHT, IN THE ORDER USERS DO THINGS

- Find my last order
- Check the basket
- Fix the gaps
- Choose delivery
- Pay and confirm

2 User Tasks

The walking skeleton: steps within each activity

UNDER EACH ACTIVITY

- See last order
- Browse past orders
- Check items
- Change amounts
- Swap missing items
- Add forgotten items
- Pick a slot
- Delivery notes
- Pay with saved card
- Get confirmation

RELEASE SLICES: STORIES GO BELOW EACH TASK, MOST IMPORTANT AT THE TOP. EACH SLICE IS A COMPLETE PATH

Release 1 · MVP

The thinnest slice that lets a user reach their goal end-to-end

Outcome: reorder in 60 s

Target: Sprint 15

- Last order card on home page
- Show items and total
- Change an amount
- Remove unavailable items
- Use their usual slot
- Pay with saved card
- Email confirmation

Release 2

Makes the journey better: more options, fewer errors

Outcome: fewer 2nd orders

Target: end of Q2

- Reorder any past order
- Suggest substitutes
- "You usually buy" list
- Choose another slot
- Leave a note
- In-app confirmation

Later

Nice to have. Revisit after learning from earlier releases

Outcome: bigger baskets

Target: Q3

- Save favourite baskets
- Share the basket with family
- Reminders for usual items
- Wallet payments

"What's the smallest slice that lets a user reach their goal end-to-end?"

"What will we learn from releasing this slice?"

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